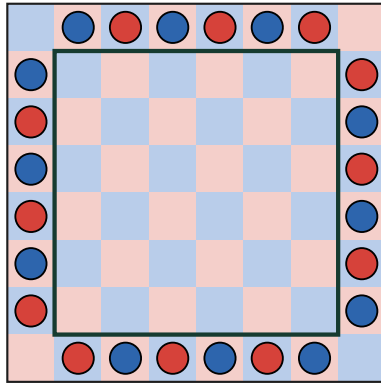


Lipfty — How to play

A two-player strategy game with shared pieces: neither player owns a colour.

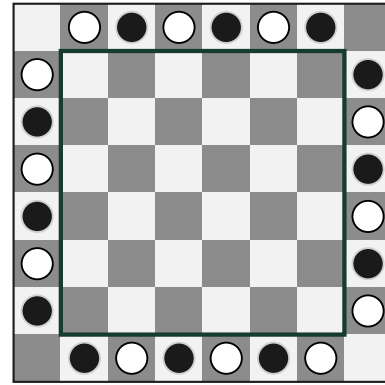
Play in your browser:

blarm1959.github.io/Lipfty



Official Lipfty set

red & blue board; 12 red + 12 blue pieces



Chess or draughts set

24 draughts; the 6×6 and corners start empty

What you need

An 8×8 board and **24 pieces**, 12 of each colour. An official **Lipfty set** is red and blue, just as a chess set is black and white: a red-and-blue board with 12 red and 12 blue pieces.

No Lipfty set? Use an ordinary chess or draughts board and the 24 draughts pieces (most chess sets come with them). Any two colours work if you can tell them apart.

Set up (see diagrams)

Play on the **inner 6×6**, which starts empty. The outside ring holds the **reserve**: put the 24 pieces round it in any order, leaving the four corners empty.

The big idea

Your opponent picks your colour. Each turn you are *handed* one reserve piece, and you must play that colour. When your turn ends, you pick a reserve piece and hand it to your opponent.

Starting: the swap rule

The other player hands the starter the first piece and the starter places it. The other player then chooses: **carry on** (they are handed a piece and play next) or **swap sides** (they take over the starter's position, hand the starter a piece, and the starter plays next). The first piece stays where it is. So place your first piece somewhere fair: if it helps the player who placed it, your opponent will simply swap.

On your turn

Use the colour you were handed and do **one** of these:

Place: put the handed piece on any empty square in the 6×6. This is always allowed.

Move (Standard/Extreme): move a board piece of the handed colour one square in any direction (including diagonally) into an empty square.

Jump (Standard/Extreme): leap a board piece of the handed colour over one adjacent piece of the *other* colour into the empty square directly beyond, in any direction. Only one jump at a time.

You may not Move or Jump the exact piece your opponent just moved on their last turn.

After a Move

Keep the piece you were handed. Your **opponent chooses** a colour, the same as your piece or the other one, takes a piece of that colour from the reserve and places it. If that doesn't win, you place the piece you were holding. Then, as normal, you choose a piece for your opponent, and they take a normal turn.

After a Jump

Lift off the piece you jumped over. You now hold two pieces, one of each colour: the one you were handed and the jumped one. Your **opponent chooses** one of them and places it on any empty square. If that doesn't win, you place the other one. Then, as normal, you choose a piece for your opponent, and they take a normal turn.

Careful: never leave three of a colour in a row with a gap after a Move or Jump. Your opponent can pick that colour and finish the line themselves.

Winning

Make a winning pattern of **one colour** (see below) and you win at once, whoever the pieces "belong" to. Check after every placement, Move, Jump and redeploy. If a Move or Jump wins, skip the steps that normally follow it.

Game versions

Learning	Place only. Four in a row: horizontal, vertical or diagonal.
Standard	Place, Move and Jump. Four in a row. <i>The usual game.</i>
Extreme	As Standard, plus 2×2 Squares and spaced Squares also win.

Ending the game

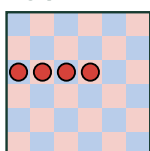
One colour runs out: as soon as the reserve has no pieces of one colour left, Move and Jump stop. Place the remaining reserve pieces one per turn. If a Move is already being settled, finish it first.

Draw: if all 24 pieces have been placed and nobody has a winning pattern, the game is a **draw**.

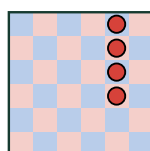
First game?

Start with **Learning** to get used to being handed your colour, then try **Standard**.

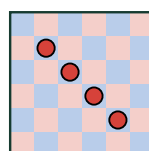
Winning patterns (four pieces of the same colour)



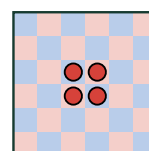
Horizontal



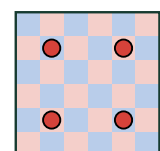
Vertical



Diagonal

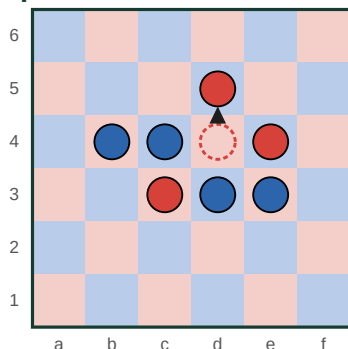


2×2 Square
Extreme only

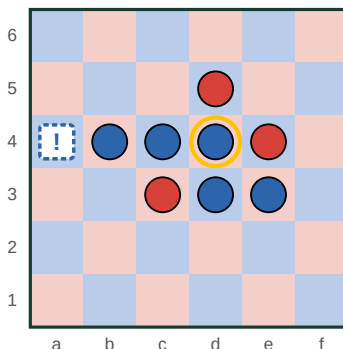


Spaced Square
Extreme only

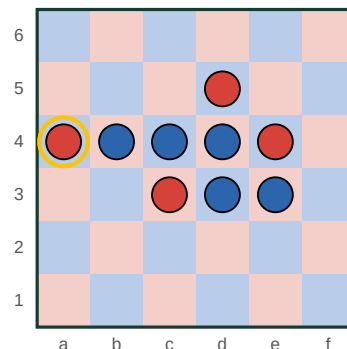
Example 1 — a Move



1. Ben hands Anna a **red**. Instead of placing it, she **Moves** her red from d4 to d5 and keeps hold of the red. (Moving e4 to e5 instead would leave three reds pointing at b2 and f6, and Ben would take red and win.)

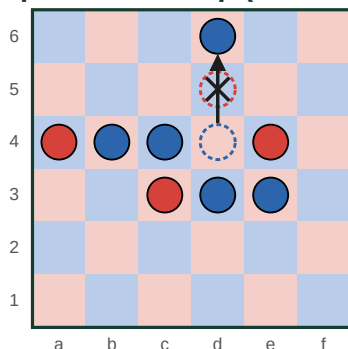


2. Ben **chooses the colour** he places. He takes a **blue** and puts it on d4, making three blues (b4–c4–d4) that point at a4.

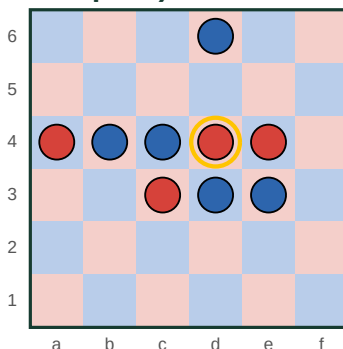


3. Anna places the red she was holding, and uses it to **block a4**. Then Ben takes a normal turn: Anna hands him a piece, and he may not Move or Jump the red on d5.

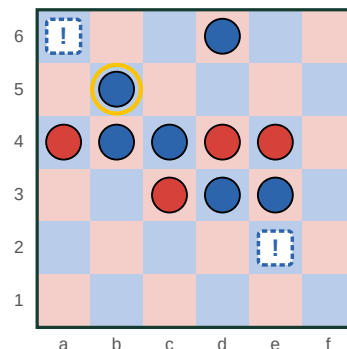
Example 2 — a Jump (continuing from Example 1)



1. Anna hands Ben a **blue**. He **Jumps** his blue from d4 over the red on d5, landing on d6. The red is lifted off, so Ben now holds **two pieces**: the blue he was handed and the red he jumped.

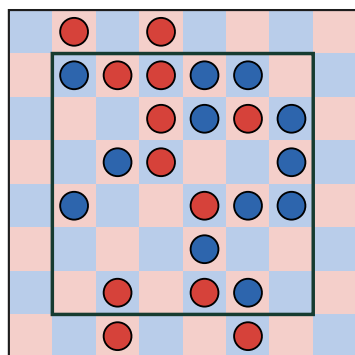


2. Anna **chooses which piece** she places. She takes the red and puts it on d4. (Had Ben jumped e3 over e4 instead, three blues would point at e4, and Anna would take the blue and win.)

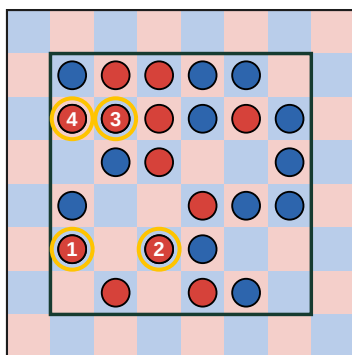


3. Ben places the other piece, his blue, on b5: three blues on the diagonal b5–c4–d3, pointing at a6 and e2. On the next turn he must hand Anna a **red**. With a blue, *she* could complete the line and win.

Example 3 — the end of the game: one colour runs out, and a draw



Blue has run out. Only four reds are left in the reserve.



All 24 placed. No one has four in a row, so it's a **draw**.

One colour runs out. As soon as the reserve has no pieces of one colour left, Move and Jump stop. The rest of the reserve is placed one piece per turn. The colour is forced, so the player whose turn it is only chooses the square.

Here blue ran out with four reds still in the reserve. They were placed in the order 1–4, each on a square that did not give the next player a winning line.

The end. When all 24 pieces have been placed and nobody has four in a row, the game is a **draw**. Draws are rare in normal play; they come up more often between very careful players.

Key **gold ring** = piece just played; **dashed circle** = where a piece came from; **X** = jumped piece lifted off; **!** = square that would complete four in a row

Remember Whoever **completes** four in a row wins, whatever the colour. So every time you hand over a piece, check whether that colour could finish a line for your opponent.

Quick reference

Start	The other player hands the starter the first piece. After it is placed they choose: carry on, or swap sides.
Normal turn	Use the handed colour: Place it, or (Standard/Extreme) Move or Jump a board piece of that colour.
After a Place	You choose a reserve piece and hand it to your opponent.
After a Move	Opponent chooses a colour and places a piece of it; then you place your held piece. Then hand your opponent a piece.
After a Jump	Opponent places one of your two pieces (handed or jumped); you place the other. Then hand your opponent a piece.
Winning move	Game over at once. Skip anything that would normally follow.